A. The Vocalic or Strong Declension.

1. The a-declension.

§ 333. The a-declension comprises masculine and neuter nouns only, and corresponds to the Latin and Greek o-declension (Lat. masc. -us, neut. -um, Gr. -ος, -ον), for which reason it is sometimes called the o-declension. The a-declension is divided into pure a-stems, ja-stems, and wa-stems.

a. Pure a-stems.

§ 334. *Masculine.*

Sing.			
Nom. Acc.	stān, *stone*	dæg, *day*	mearh, *horse*
Gen.	stānes	dæges	mēares
Dat.	stāne	dæge	mēare
Plur.			
Nom. Acc.	stānas	dagas	mēaras
Gen.	stāna	daga	mēara
Dat.	stānum	dagum	mēarum

Note.—The gen. sing. ended in -æs in the oldest period of the language, and in late OE. occasionally in -as, -ys. The oldest ending of the dat. sing. is -æ. The dat. sing. is generally used for the instrumental, so that this case is omitted in the paradigms. In the oldest period of the language the instrumental (originally a locative) ended in -i, later -y, and corresponded to the Gr. loc. ending οἴκ-ει, *at home*, not to οἴκ-οι which would have become -e in OE. as in the dat. (§ 217). In late OE. the dat. pl. ended in -un, -on, -an (§ 284).

The prim. Germanic forms of dæg were: Sing. nom. *đaȝaz, acc. *đaȝan, gen. *đaȝesa or *đaȝasa (with pronominal ending, § 465), dat. *đaȝai, instr. *đaȝī; Plural nom. *đaȝōz (cp. Goth. dagōs), acc. *đaȝanz (cp. Goth. dagans), gen. *đaȝōn (cp. Gr. θεῶν, *of gods*), dat. *đaȝomiz.